9.10. Home remedies

The following foods are suggested to reduce the blood sugar levels and complications of diabetes:

- Fenugreek
- Jamun fruit
- Green leafy vegetables
- Sprouts
- Varagu
- Thinai
- Curry leaves
- Cinnamon

14th November is World Diabetes Day

Effective blood glucose control measures with healthy diet, physical activity and drugs not only allow the diabetics to lead a normal healthy life but also prevent the complications associated with diabetes.

YOU SHOULD CONTROL DIABETES OTHERWISE IT WILL CONTROL YOU

SUMMARY

- Diabetes mellitus is a chronic metabolic disorder that prevents the body to utilize glucose completely or partially.
- It is characterized by raised glucose concentration in the blood and alterations in carbohydrate, fat and protein metabolism.
- One in every eight individuals in India is a diabetic.
- The average age for the onset of diabetes is around 40 years while it is around 55 years in other countries.
- The types of Diabetes are Type 1 or Insulin dependent Diabetes mellitus, Type 2 or Non insulin dependent Diabetes mellitus. Gestational diabetes, Malnutrition related Diabetes mellitus and Secondary Diabetes.
- The main cause of type 1 diabetes is infection.
- The main causes of type 2 Diabetes are heredity, age, stress and obesity.
- The main symptoms of diabetes are polyuria, polyphagia, polydipsia, fatigue and delayed wound healing.
- There are alterations in carbohydrate, protein and fat metabolism for a diabetic. The following are the diagnostic test for Diabetes- Fasting blood glucose, Random plasma glucose and Oral Glucose Tolerance Test.
- The main modes of treatment in Diabetes are Diet, Insulin, Drugs, Exercise and Education.
- The acute complications of Diabetes include hypoglycaemia and Diabetic acidosis and coma.
- The chronic complications are retinopathy, nephropathy, neuropathy and cardiomyopathy.
- Non caloric and high intense sweeteners are available as sugar substitutes for a diabetic.
- Effective blood glucose control measures with healthy diet, physical activity and drugs not only allow the diabetics to lead a normal healthy life but also prevent the complications associated with diabetes.

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